

EMMA RACKSTRAW

www.emmarackstraw.com

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Email: emma.rackstraw@gmail.com

Citizenship: USA

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- Assistant Professor of Economics, Swarthmore College, August 2025-
- SSRC Criminal Justice Innovation Postdoctoral Fellow, Quattrone Center at UPenn Carey Law School, July 2024- July 2025

EDUCATION

- Harvard University, Ph.D. in Public Policy (Economics Track), 2024
- Wellesley College, B.A. in Economics (Major) and Music (Minor), 2014

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor/public economics

Additional: Economics of crime, experimental economics, behavioral economics, economics of discrimination

WORKING PAPERS

- When Reality TV Creates Reality: How “Copaganda” Affects Police, Communities, and Viewers. Available at [SSRN](#).
- Bias-Motivated Updating in the Labor Market. Available at [SSRN](#).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Background Check Adjudication & Fair Chance Hiring. (with Amanda Agan & David Autor)
- Sticky Stereotypes: Inaccurate Beliefs and Observability. (with Anna Gifty Opoku-Agyeman)

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

- 2023: Program in Criminal Justice Grantee, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy Research Grantee, Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grantee, Academy of Management Doctoral Consortium Scholarship, Women and Public Policy Program Grantee*
- 2021: ReSTAT Research Grantee, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative Grantee
- 2020: HKS Wiener Center for Social Policy Pilot Grantee; Peggy Howard Fellowship for Graduate Study in Economics; Radcliffe Engaged Summer Grantee
- 2019: National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program
- 2014: Natalie Bolton Faculty Prize in International Economics; Phi Beta Kappa

*Co-author PI

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Invited Seminars:

- 2025: Lafayette College
- 2024: Minneapolis Fed Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Initiative (OIGI), Penn Criminology Colloquium, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE)
- 2023: HKS Economics and Social Policy, Wellesley Initiative for Scholars of Economics (WISE)

External Conferences and Workshops:

- 2025: American Economic Association Meeting (AEA)
- 2024: Society of Labor Economists (SOLE)*, Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL), National Bureau of Economic Research Summer Institute (NBERSI), SABE-IAREP, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (TWECE)*, PPE Society, American Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)
- 2023: AEA, Western Economic Association International Meeting (WEAI), NBERSI, Academy of Management Meeting (AoM), APPAM
- 2022: Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW)
- 2019: Association of American Law Schools (AALS)
- 2018: American Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)

*Co-Author Presenting

Referee Service: Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Public Economics, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Justice Quarterly.

TEACHING

Teaching Interests: Econometrics, Labor Economics, Microeconomics, Experimental Economics, Academic Writing, Causal Inference, Discrimination, Behavioral Economics

Teaching Experience:

- Empirical Methods II for MPPs, Harvard Kennedy School, 2021
- Evaluation Course for Chief Evaluation Officers, Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Executive Education Course in Randomized Evaluation, J-PAL at MIT, 2019
- Econometrics for Undergraduates, Wellesley College, 2013

PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

- Research Assistant for Will Dobbie, Harvard Kennedy School, 2019 - 2022
 - Provided research assistance for criminal justice and discrimination related projects and courses
- Research Consultant
 - PDQuery (unpaid), 2022-present
 - Crime and Justice Policy Lab, University of Pennsylvania, 2021-present
 - Everytown for Gun Safety, 2018-19

- Associate Fellow (Academic IPA), Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
 - Designed curriculum on research methods and evaluation
- Senior Policy Associate, J-PAL North America at MIT, 2016 - 2019
 - Led Crime and Political Economy & Governance sectors
- Research Economist, Council of Economic Advisers, 2014 - 2016
 - Provided economic analysis in labor and education policy

SKILLS

Data & Software: Stata (Advanced), R (Proficient), $\text{\LaTeX}$ (Proficient), Zotero (Proficient), Excel (Proficient), Python (Basic)

Languages: English (Native), French (Proficient), Spanish (Basic)

Talents: Singing (Semi-Professional), Glassblowing (Amateur)

SERVICE

Professional Service: Kennedy School PhD Students' Association President (2021-2022), PhD Peer Mentor (2020-present), HKS Anti-Racism in Economics Founding Member (2020-2022), Organizer of Economics of Discrimination Reading Group (2020-2021)

Community Service: Morris Animal Refuge Volunteer (2022-present), Prison Volunteer in MA DOC (2017-2020) and PA DOC (2022-present), Meals on Wheels Volunteer (2020-2023)